

Tab 1

Names: Michelle, Lamson

Workshop

1. Common Issues:

- Struggled to balance the film analysis and arguments.
- Leaned too much on summarizing the movie rather than connecting it to the social issue.
- Strong reasoning was not always connected to a source.

2. Common Strengths:

- Used good examples from the film to represent the human impact of the issue.
- Use of emotional and persuasive writing
- Strong personal writing, clearly showing care about the topic and thesis

3. Feedback:

- I could make the film connections clearer and direct towards the modern vaping crisis
- I got feedback to clarify my conclusion and emphasize the possible solutions to this issue of corporate manipulation.

4. Overall Experience

- This process of writing the essay step-by-step has been good for developing my essay and its structure
- The entire process has felt drawn out, with unnecessary assignments along the way.

5. How this essay changed my understanding of the issue:

- Writing about *The Insider* helped me continue my research about the social issue and its human impact, as well as its corporate issues with whistleblowing and manipulation.
- The film gave a better understanding compared to the meme and advertisements.
- The process helped me understand and expand on my knowledge and think critically about how I compose my ideas.

Lansom

1. Thesis and Central Argument
 - The thesis is clear: ICE divides families, harms immigrants, and weakens the country
 - You could include the film to widen your social issue and show how ICE dehumanizes immigrants.
2. Representation of the Social Issue
 - The essay shows how ICE frames immigrants as criminals rather than innocent humans who are trying to rebuild their lives.
 - You could go deeper into how the documentary persuades the audience through empathy, call-to-action, etc.
3. Evidence and Support
 - Strong use of credible sources (Washington Post, USA Today, etc) alongside scenes from the documentary
 - Balancing the use of description with interpretation. Integrate some quotes or statistics to strengthen your argument.
4. Organization and Development
 - The essay flows nicely and logically through your three major points.
 - You could improve the transitions and link each paragraph towards the central claim in a possible topic sentence or transition sentence.
5. Context and Insight
 - The essay gives political context (from the 1790s to Trump's presidency)
 - Expand on why this issue is important today in 2025. Possibly include the definition of the “American Dream” and how it may be moving farther out of reach for most people.

Michelle

1. Thesis and Central Argument

- The thesis is clear, with three main points
- You could strengthen it further by connecting the harms to the ethical issues that come with pollution

2. Representation of the Social Issue

- The essay effectively shows the issue as an environmental and social issue. The use of scenes from *A Plastic Ocean* is a good use of evidence of how animals suffer due to pollution
- You could expand more on how the documentaries use ethos/pathos/logos to persuade the audience.

3. Evidence and Support

- The essay uses credible sources such as National Geographic and [Earth.Org](https://www.earth.org/)
- You could deepen your analysis and use direct quotes or statistics from your sources to strengthen your argument

4. Organization and Development

- There is a nice structure, with each paragraph addressing one of the three main concerns addressed in the introduction.
- You could look into improving some of your transitions and possibly a concluding sentence for each paragraph to tie it back to the thesis.

5. Context and Insight

- You give a clear environmental context about the current situation regarding pollution in marine life.
- You could include some more social or even economic context as to why this is such an important topic to address.